

rants weigh most? “ROI and career outcomes increasingly trump brand prestige,” affirms Aman Singh, Co-founder of Grad Right, a platform helping students with foreign education.

“For Indian students pursuing MBAs overseas, return on investment (ROI) has become a critical decision-making criterion,” he adds.

Tamanna Bhatia, a student from Newcastle University, says, “For many aspirants, the key is to measure the total cost against potential earnings and opportunities—finding that sweet spot where investment directly translates into career mobility.”

The financial calculus varies widely across countries. In the US and Canada, the high average post-MBA salaries come with steep tuition and living costs, making ROI a tight equation. “While premium programmes offer unparalleled networking and career opportunities,” notes Ghosal, “the expenses are also the highest, which means students must carefully weigh whether the salary uplift justifies the upfront investment.”

In contrast, Germany and France present more affordable options, with moderate salary prospects but attractive stay-back policies, especially for students looking to contain costs.

Similarly, in Asia, Singapore offers a strategic middle ground, with competitive salaries and lower overall costs, making it an increasingly popular choice for ROI-focused students. Ultimately, the decision hinges on balancing cost, visa clarity, location, and the reputation of the business school, elements that can significantly determine long-term financial and career outcomes.



“Treat housing like a second tuition. Book early, budget for multiple deposits, and sync the lease start with visa validity”

SAURABH ARORA

Founder & CEO,
University Living



“With rising costs, students are scrutinising which destinations and institutions offer the best balance between affordability and salary prospects”

ARITRA GHOSAL

Founder and CEO,
OneStep Global

THE FUTURE

For international MBA aspirants, the real pay-off often comes not just from the degree, but from the opportunity to work during and after their studies.

As Balakrishna Grandhi, Dean, Global MBA & Master of Global Business at SP Jain School of Global Management, observes, “The availability and duration of post-study work permits play a key role, enabling graduates to gain international experience, build professional networks, and strengthen long-term career prospects.”

In 2025, the global landscape has defined by a patchwork of job rights and part-time work regulations, shaping how Indian students budget, network, and strategise their path to global employability.

While most destinations allow some of on- or off-campus work during term time, helping students finance living costs and build local experience, the real differentiator lies in the breadth and duration of post-graduation work permits.

The perceived value gap between international and Indian MBAs is closing, though international MBAs still provide invaluable exposure.

Pardeshi reflects, “The experience abroad enhances global networking... Indian MBAs remain strong academically, but the international ecosystem shapes long-term careers.”

However, for many, high ROI, industry linkage, and rising global recognition of India’s top programs make them more attractive than ever, especially when weighed against escalating tuition, housing, and visa hurdles abroad. **BT**

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